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White smoke signals new pope chosen

VATICAN CITY

White smoke billowed from the chimney of the Sistine Chapel yesterday, signalling that cardinals locked inside have elected a new leader for the world's 1.4 billion Catholics.

Thousands of pilgrims and curious onlookers in St Peter's Square cheered and applauded as the smoke appeared and bells began to ring, indicating the 2,000-year-old institution has its 267th pope.

All eyes turned to the balcony of St Peter's Basilica, to see who has been elected to succeed Pope Francis, an Argentine reformer who died last month after 12 years as leader of the Church.

The new pontiff will be introduced in Latin with his chosen papal name and address the world for the first time.

— AFP

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YAS ISLAND SHINES BRIGHT FOR DISNEY THEME PARK REVEAL

History was made on Yas Island in Abu Dhabi as The Walt Disney Company and Miral officially announced the arrival of the Middle East and Africa's first-ever Disney theme park resort. In a breathtaking celebration that captivated thousands, over 9,000 drones lit up the night sky, setting a new regional record and creating a visual spectacle that embodied the magic of Disney.

SEE ALSO P15

Several sites in Jammu hit by rockets

Parts of Rajasthan and Punjab were also targeted with rockets

DUBAI

Multiple locations in Jammu, including the airstrip, were targeted yesterday night with rockets fired from across the International Border, marking a major escalation a day after India struck several alleged terror camps in Pakistan and Pakistan-administered Kashmir, reports in the Indian media said.

Parts of Rajasthan and Punjab were also targeted with rockets fired from across the

International Border with Pakistan, marking a significant escalation just a day after India struck terror camps in Pakistan and Pakistan-administered Kashmir, reports said.

Jammu airport hit

One of the drones hit the Jammu airport, prompting fighter jets to scramble in response. India activated its air defence systems, which successfully intercepted the incoming rockets.

Shesh Paul Vaid, a former director general of police for Jammu and Kashmir, also wrote on social media that there were "loud explosions".

Earlier, Pakistan's army shot

down several Indian drones over major cities, including Lahore, Rawalpindi and outside Karachi, a spokesman told reporters yesterday. India's Ministry of Defence separately said in a statement it "neutralised" Pakistan's attempt to strike a "number of military targets in Northern and Western India" using drones and missiles on Wednesday and yesterday.

The military action raised concern of a significant escalation in hostilities between the nuclear-armed neighbours, prompting a plunge in Pakistan stocks and the biggest drop in India's rupee in three years.

— Gulf News Report

SEE ALSO P12

1 million people to benefit from new airport plan

CONTRACTS OVER DH1B AWARDED
TOWARDS BUILDING PHASE 1 OF DWC

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN

Chief Reporter

The first phase of developing the proposed passenger terminal at Al Maktoum International Airport, also known as Dubai World Central, is "progressing well", according to a top official with the Dubai Aviation Engineering Projects (DAEP).

Khalifa Al Zaffin, the Executive Chairman of DAEP and the executive chairman of Dubai Aviation City Corporation and Dubai South, told media on the sidelines of Dubai Airport Show that contracts surpassing Dh1 billion have been awarded towards the construction of Phase 1 of the airport in Dubai South, including constructing a second runway. DAEP has been entrusted with the design and execution of this transformative airport programme.

Jobs and housing

According to Al Zaffin, economically, the project is expected to support up to 1 million people through employment and housing, which is integral to the development of Dubai South — a master-planned city and logistics hub where the new airport will be based.

Al Zaffin confirmed that the project's first phase could reach completion by 2032, with full completion slated for the early

EMIRATES SOARS

The Emirates Group, comprising Emirates airline and dnata, has announced a record-breaking profit before tax of Dh 22.7 billion for the financial year ended March 31, 2025. This outstanding performance marks an 18 per cent increase from the previous year and positions the company as the "world's most profitable aviation group in the 2024-25 reporting period."

Emirates airline itself achieved its best-ever result, becoming the world's most profitable airline with a record profit before tax of Dh21.2 billion, a substantial 20 per cent increase from the previous year.

— D. G.

2030s. He said, "The design is being done, and we have already started work on the ground." The airport will be a technological marvel, where we are trying to make (the passenger journey) smooth, with a lot of passenger delights."

Upon completing phase 1, Al Zaffin said the terminal's capacity will increase to approximately 150 million passengers annually.

The ultimate goal is to reach a target capacity of 260 million passengers and 12 tonnes of cargo per year.

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